

# PROSPER AWUNI

## Senior Microsoft Sentinel / Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) Engineer

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### PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineer with deep, hands-on expertise in Microsoft Sentinel deployment, detection engineering, KQL (Kusto Query Language) query development, and enterprise-wide log ingestion across hybrid and multi-cloud environments. I have designed and implemented custom analytics rules, data connectors, and SOAR (Security Orchestration, Automation and Response) automation pipelines that deliver measurable improvements in threat detection and incident response capability. My background spans identity, endpoint, cloud, and network security telemetry, which gives me a broad understanding of the security data landscape that feeds a well-tuned SIEM. I have used PowerShell scripting extensively to automate security operations tasks and have engineered SIEM content aligned with the MITRE ATT&CK framework to improve detection of real-world adversary behaviours. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and am based in the United Kingdom, available for hybrid working.

### CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel deployment and optimisation (enterprise and SMC scale), log onboarding, standard and custom data connectors, analytics rules, workbooks
- **KQL and Detection Engineering:** Advanced KQL for threat detection, hunting queries, and analytics rule development; MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection content
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel automation (Logic Apps / playbooks), PowerShell scripting, API integrations, SOAR playbook engineering
- **Log Ingestion and Telemetry:** Log onboarding across identity, endpoint, cloud, and network layers; hybrid and multi-cloud log ingestion; custom parsers and Function App pipelines
- **Endpoint and XDR Telemetry:** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender XDR
- **Identity Security Telemetry:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Conditional Access, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Cloud Security Telemetry:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender, cloud-native security signals
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Scripting:** PowerShell, KQL; experience with API-based integrations and automated ingestion pipelines
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

### PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

#### University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer March 2025 - Present

- Own and optimise enterprise-wide log onboarding into Microsoft Sentinel, deploying standard and custom data connectors to ingest security telemetry across identity, endpoint, cloud, and network layers for an 8,000-user environment.
- Build and maintain tailored SIEM detection content including analytics rules, KQL hunting queries, and workbooks, aligned with MITRE ATT&CK to improve identification of adversary tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs).
- Engineer and maintain SOAR automation playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and PowerShell, automating triage, notification, containment, and ticket creation workflows to reduce mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Manage ingestion pipelines and ensure log coverage across hybrid on-premises and cloud environments, including Microsoft Entra ID, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft 365, and CrowdStrike Falcon telemetry.

- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules, maintaining sensor policies, detection tuning, and real-time response capabilities alongside the Sentinel SIEM environment.
- Conduct threat hunting using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying anomalous behaviour and lateral movement not surfaced by automated alerting.
- Serve as an escalation point for complex ingestion, telemetry coverage, and investigation challenges, advising on detection strategy and SIEM architecture improvements.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) controls, ensuring identity-layer telemetry feeds correctly into Sentinel analytics pipelines.
- Lead vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), integrating findings into the broader security operations workflow.

### **University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity**

*March 2022 - March 2025*

- Deployed and configured Microsoft Sentinel data connectors, analytics rules, and automated playbooks to build out the organisation's SIEM and SOAR capability from the ground up.
- Developed KQL-based detection rules and hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel, tuning content to reduce false positives and improve detection coverage across identity, endpoint, and email attack vectors.
- Onboarded security telemetry from Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, and CrowdStrike Falcon into Microsoft Sentinel, ensuring complete log coverage.
- Built and maintained SOAR automation playbooks using Logic Apps and PowerShell scripts, automating alert enrichment, ticket creation, and response actions.
- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon EDR policies, managed sensor deployment, and tuned detection rules to reduce alert fatigue and improve signal quality for the SIEM.
- Triaged, investigated, and responded to SIEM alerts, applying NIST SP 800-61 incident response methodology and MITRE ATT&CK for adversary behaviour mapping.
- Supported the delivery of vulnerability management scans using Nessus and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports for infrastructure teams.
- Managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, ensuring endpoint compliance signals fed correctly into SIEM telemetry.

### **HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure**

*February 2021 - March 2022*

- Delivered security engineering within a cloud-native Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, supporting secure operations and log management practices.
- Configured and maintained endpoint security and identity tooling, supporting MFA and Single Sign-On (SSO) implementations across internal and client-facing systems.
- Administered vulnerability scanning and coordinated remediation with development and infrastructure teams, maintaining a continuous improvement cycle aligned with ISO 27001 principles.
- Supported the implementation of security monitoring and automation processes, contributing to incident response readiness and operational security tooling.

## **KEY ACHIEVEMENTS**

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- Deployed and optimised enterprise-wide Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environment for an 8,000-user organisation, including custom data connectors, KQL analytics rules, and SOAR playbooks that reduced MTTR significantly.
- Built MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection content in Microsoft Sentinel that improved identification of identity-based attacks, lateral movement, and phishing-driven threats.
- Engineered CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR deployment across 8,000 users, integrating endpoint telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for unified detection and response.
- Delivered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment at scale, enriching SIEM telemetry and enabling cross-domain threat correlation.
- Developed and deployed SOAR automation playbooks that automated triage, enrichment, and containment for common alert types, freeing analyst capacity for complex investigations.

- Integrated Tenable.io and Pentera BAS findings into the security operations workflow, enabling risk-based prioritisation of vulnerability remediation aligned with the active threat landscape.

## EDUCATION

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- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

## CERTIFICATIONS

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- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
  - CompTIA Security+
  - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
  - CompTIA A+
  - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (UK)